EXHIBIT 2

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT

CENTRAL DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA

ROBERTO SANDOVAL CARRILLO, individually and on behalf of all others similarly situated, Plaintiffs, vs. THE VONS COMPANIES, INC.; ONE SOURCE TECHNOLOGY LLC d/b/a ASURINT, and DOES 1-5. Defendants.	)	**CASE NO.** 8:25-cv-00191-SRM-KES

DEPOSITION OF

TONI NORTH
PERSON MOST KNOWLEDGEABLE OF
THE VONS COMPANIES, INC.

DATE: Wednesday, October 29, 2025

TIME: 9:03 AM to 6:03 PM

REPORTER: Michelle Dichirico, CSR No.13779

VIA REMOTE VIDEO TECHNOLOGY

Hines Reporters

INTERNATIONAL TOWER
888 S. FIGUEROA STREET, SUITE 940, LOS ANGELES, CALIFORNIA 90017
866.432.4300

LOS ANGELES * SAN FRANCISCO * SAN DIEGO

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT

CENTRAL DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA

ROBERTO SANDOVAL CARRILLO, individually and on behalf of all others similarly situated,

Plaintiffs,

vs.

THE VONS COMPANIES, INC.; ONE SOURCE TECHNOLOGY LLC d/b/a ASURINT, and DOES 1-5.

Defendants.

Case No.: 8:25-cv-00191-SRM-KES

VIDEOCONFERENCE DEPOSITION OF

THE PERSON MOST KNOWLEDGEABLE FOR

THE VONS COMPANIES, INC.

BY AND THROUGH

TONI NORTH

OCTOBER 29, 2025

Reported by:
Michelle Dichirico
CSR Number 13779

BY MR. KIM:

Q So what else did you look at with respect to Mr. Carrillo's hiring?

MS. LAMAR: Asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: I guess I don't understand the question. I don't understand what you're talking about.

BY MR. KIM:

Q So would you agree with me that Albertsons conditionally hired Mr. Carrillo for employment at a Vons store?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope, calls for speculation, asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: Yes.

BY MR. KIM:

Q So what information was reviewed when Mr. Carrillo was conditionally hired?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; vague and ambiguous.

THE DEPONENT: I don't know.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Did you respond you don't know?

A Yes.

Q Are you aware that Mr. Carrillo's conditional offer of employment was rescinded?

A Yes.

Q Why was it rescinded?

A If you mean initially, it was the review of his previous conviction, if he disclosed at time of offer, and his criminal convictions.

Q What do you mean by "initially"?

A The initial process starts the pre-adverse action, but I'm referring again to the standard operating procedures.

That notice initiates the adverse action process and allows disputing, and we review all of that information provided to us by the potential candidate.

Q Where is all of that information stored?

A Some of it, when it comes through Asurint, is tracked as part of the background check report.

Some of it comes through our criminal.checks mailbox that is referred to in the pre-adverse action letter. Those e-mail communications are saved indefinitely.

Q Which e-mail communications?

A To the criminal.checks@albertsons.com.

Q Is there a name for the Asurint site --

MS. LAMAR: Objection; vague and ambiguous.

THE DEPONENT: I don't know.

MR. KIM: So if you can let me finish my question.

///

BY MR. KIM:

Q Is there a name for the Asurint site that you review to look at background check reports?

A I just go to the www.asurint.com. Of course access is limited, and I have to enter a password.

Q So there's a specific portal for Asurint's clients that Albertsons would use to obtain the background report information?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope as it relates to what Albertsons does, also calls for speculation.

You can answer with respect to Vons.

THE DEPONENT: Yes.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Ms. North, this document here, again, Bates Numbers 118 to 119, the standard operating procedures, again, this says "Albertsons Companies" at the top right; isn't that right?

MS. LAMAR: The document speaks for itself.

THE DEPONENT: Yes.

BY MR. KIM:

Q And this is the standard operating procedures used by the Albertsons Companies; isn't that correct?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope.

I'm going to instruct you not to answer. You

can answer as it relates to Vons.

THE DEPONENT: Yes.

MR. KIM: Okay. I'm going to introduce Exhibit 3.

(Exhibit 3 was marked for identification.)

BY MR. KIM:

Q Ms. North, have you seen this document before?

A Yes.

Q Could you read the title for us, please?

A "Defendant The Vons Companies, Inc.'s Supplemental Objections and Responses to Plaintiff Roberto Sandoval Carrillo's Requests for Production of Documents, Set One."

Q Did you assist your counsel in searching for documents in response to Mr. Carrillo's requests for production?

A Yes.

Q Did you review this document before it was served to my office on October 10th?

A Yes.

Q And then did you review this document in preparation for today's deposition?

A No.

Q So you'll see here Request for Production Number 2:

A Myself and Courtney Jones.
Q Who is Courtney Jones?
A Courtney Jones is my direct report. She's a compliance adjudicator.
Q So she reports to you?
A Yes.
Q Is she a part of the AEC department?
A Yes.
Q How many other compliance adjudicators report to you?
A Zero.
Q How many other compliance adjudicators are there in California?
A Zero.
Q I'm sorry?
MS. LAMAR: Objection; calls for speculation.
THE DEPONENT: Zero.
BY MR. KIM:
Q What does a compliance adjudicator do?
A They go through each of the background check reports that are returned from Asurint and adjudicate them.
Q What do you mean by "adjudicate"?
A Make a preliminary decision as to whether the person is to be hired or not.

A None that were not privileged.

Q Did you find communications that were privileged?

A I don't remember.

Q Where did you search for this information?

A I searched in the criminal.checks e-mail as well as my own work e-mail.

Q And the criminal.checks e-mail, who has access to that e-mail address?

A Myself and Courtney Jones.

Q Anyone else?

A No.

Q Do you exchange communication through any other platforms, such as Slack or Teams or text message, for instance?

A We have access to Teams. I don't use it.

Q And how did you conduct the search through your criminal.checks e-mail and your work e-mail?

A Both are part of the Outlook system, and I used the search function to search all mailboxes.

Q So what is the Megan's Law?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope, calls for a legal conclusion.

THE DEPONENT: I know the portion that responds to background checks, which is that we need to not rely

BY MR. KIM:

Q So based on your understanding as an AEC manager, in what circumstances can Vons use registry information from the Megan's Law for employment decisions?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope, calls for a legal conclusion.

I'm going to instruct her not to answer with respect to her role or on behalf of Vons, but she can answer based on her own knowledge.

THE DEPONENT: It doesn't apply to Mr. Sandoval Carrillo because he gave us a lot of mitigating information that we also used.

More importantly, he disclosed the conviction at the time of offer.

BY MR. KIM:

Q How do you know that he disclosed the conviction at the time of offer?

A Through their personal identifying information, the first thing I see on the background check from Asurint, the report, comes over from our applicant tracking system and shows precisely what the person responded to that question at time of offer.

Q So you receive that information at the time you receive the background report?

Q Okay. So Vons responded:

"Responding Party will produce its Standard Operating Procedures re Use and Review of Retail Job Applicants' Criminal Conviction Histories."

Do you see that?

A Yes.

Q Okay. Did you search for policies and procedures responsive to RFP Number 12?

A Yes.

Q Other than the standard operating procedures referenced here, were any other documents found?

A The training guide.

Q Is that the training guide that we just referenced that Courtney had used when she was trained?

A Yes.

Q And when was Courtney Jones hired?

A I don't remember.

Q Has she been employed with you for more than five years?

A No.

Q Has she been employed for more than two years?

A Yes.

Q Was she working for Vons -- and when I say "Vons," I'm including Safeway and Albertsons.

Was she working for Vons in 2022?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope.

You can answer as it relates to Vons, if you know.

THE DEPONENT: I don't remember.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Was she working in January of 2023 for Vons?

A Yes.

Q So other than this training guide, are there any other documents, privileged or non-privileged, that would be responsive to Request for Production Number 12?

A No.

Q So Request for Production Number 13 seeks:

"Your employee training manuals relating to conducting an individualized assessment of whether the applicant's conviction history has a direct and adverse relationship with the specific duties of the job that justify denying the applicant the position."

Do you see that?

A Yes.

Q Okay. Did you search for information responsive to RFP 13?

A Yes.

I'm going to instruct you not to answer.

MR. KIM: Ray, follow up.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Okay. To ensure we're on the same page, when we talk about The Vons Companies, are we also including Pavilions, Ms. North?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope, asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: I don't know.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Doesn't Pavilions fall under The Vons Companies?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope, asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: I don't know.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Doesn't Safeway fall under The Vons Companies?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; asked and answered.

I'm going to instruct you not to answer.

MR. KIM: Ray, follow up.

BY MR. KIM:

Q So, Ms. North, when does this standard operating procedure that we're looking at, when does it come -- when is it used as a part of the hiring process?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; lacks foundation,

assumes facts.

THE DEPONENT: This would be used after a conditional offer of employment was made.

BY MR. KIM:

Q So is it after every conditional offer of employment is made the standard operating procedures regarding use and review of retail job applicants' criminal conviction histories in California is used?

A For Vons, yes.

Q So it is used whether or not the background report includes conviction history information?

A Yes.

Q So how is it used when the background report does not have conviction history information?

A Anyone who has disclosed a previous conviction will return to Courtney and I for review.

Q At that point, what do you and/or Courtney do?

A That would be Step 3.

We would look at what they put in and determine the nature and gravity of the offense, the time that has passed, the nature of the job being sought, et cetera.

Q So what is Step 2?

A Step 2 is to make sure that we are not getting anything back, and this is followed by Asurint.

They don't give us anything that's an arrest,

that's a probation before judgment, that's been statutorily eradicated. Those things simply are not returned on the background check report.

Q How do you do that?

A I don't know.

Q You don't know how you make sure that you're not getting anything back that has an arrest or probation before judgment or that has been statutorily eradicated?

A No, Asurint does that for us.

Q So Asurint does Step 2; is that right?

A Yes.

Q Okay. What's Step 1?

MR. DRURY: I have an objection.

Object to the question, and that misstates her prior testimony. That is not what she testified to.

BY MR. KIM:

Q What is Step 1?

A Step 1 is basically ensuring that we're not conducting or starting to conduct a background check until an offer has been extended.

Q So with respect to Step 3, could you describe Step 3 in further detail?

MS. LAMAR: The document speaks for itself.

THE DEPONENT: I literally would just be reading from the document.

I'm looking at what job they're applying for, what their convictions are for, how long ago the conviction were, how serious the conviction was, the nature of the conviction, and whether I feel it poses a threat to employees, customers, or vendors.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Okay. So -- oh, so you're looking actually at Step 3 here in the document?

A Yes.

Q Got it. Okay.

And then is it in this order that you follow?

A Not necessarily. It's comprehensive but not necessarily in that order.

Q So what do you mean by "not necessarily," "it's comprehensive"?

A We do all those steps. Whether we do A before B before C, not always. We might do C first.

Q Will you do Step 3 before Step 2?

A Perhaps.

Q So you'll do the conditional offer of employment --

A Oh, I'm sorry. No, I'm sorry. I was looking at A, B, C. I apologize.

No, these steps always go in the order that are there.

Q So it will go Step 1, 2, 3, 4, 5? In that order?

A I believe so. I would have to read the document comprehensively. You're scrolling kind of fast.

Q Okay. Do you want me to start -- where should I -- I'll go to page 1 first.

A So yes, the conditional offer of employment would be the first step, and then the receipt of the background check request to Asurint.

And then following through on it would be Step 2, which would include making sure all that information is redacted.

And then Step 3 would be us actually doing the preliminary, first run adjudication.

Yes, that's correct.

Q And here I scrolled down to Step 4 and 5.

A And this is going through the pre-adverse action process, that's correct. That would happen after the adjudication.

And Step 5, the adverse action, would be after that.

Yes, those are in order.

Q So you generally follow these five steps in this order; is that right?

MS. LAMAR: Asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: Yes.

BY MR. KIM:

Q And then with respect to Step 2, I believe you said information is redacted?

A That's my understanding. That's completed by Asurint.

Q What do you mean by "information is redacted"?

A My understanding is that if something comes up that's an arrest not followed by a conviction, for example, that that gets removed from the report that's sent on to us. That's part of their quality assurance process.

Q Got it.

So Asurint will remove that information before you get the background report; is that right?

A Yes.

Q So with respect to Step 3, what information is considered?

MS. LAMAR: Asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: What's listed there: the nature and gravity, the time that's passed, nature of the job being sought.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Does Vons, as a part of its individualized assessment, interview candidates?

characteristic, an ID number, the time the applicant applied?

A It's difficult to answer the question only because there's so many of them. Anyone who does not pass the background check can open a dispute.

Q But I'm asking specifically an example of somebody that was interviewed.

And by "interview," I mean either a phone call or a Zoom videoconference or an in-person interview to discuss the conviction and the candidate's fitness for the specific position.

A I don't know how to respond. It happens all the time.

Q Who conducts those interviews?

A Myself and Courtney Jones.

Q When you say "all of the time," what do you mean by "all of the time"?

A I don't have a track on this, so I would be entirely guessing.

Q Well, I'll represent to you that Vons responded that there are approximately 717 persons in California, through February of 2025, with conviction histories who applied for employment, went through the background check process, and were denied employment.

A Yes.

MS. LAMAR: Objection; calls for speculation, asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: I don't know.

BY MR. KIM:

Q How long do these interviews normally last?

MS. LAMAR: Calls for speculation.

THE DEPONENT: It varies tremendously.

BY MR. KIM:

Q On what?

A Whether I can get ahold of the person, whether they call me back, what their disclosure was on their application, what their criminal conviction was, what job they're applying to.

All of the factors we reviewed previously.

Q Where are the records of these interviews?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; assumes facts.

THE DEPONENT: We make a note in the background check report saying we received a voicemail on such and such a date or we have an e-mail on such and such a date.

BY MR. KIM:

Q So that information is in the background check report?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; misstates testimony.

THE DEPONENT: It's included in the remarks that had been stored with the background check report.

MS. LAMAR: Calls for speculation.

THE DEPONENT: Perhaps one of the attorneys.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Where is this document stored?

A I don't know.

Q Where did you obtain this document from?

A From our confidential shared drive.

Q So it's stored in Vons's confidential shared drive?

MS. LAMAR: Asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: I have a copy of it there. I don't know where the official document is stored.

BY MR. KIM:

Q And who has access to the shared drive?

A Myself, Courtney Jones.

Q Anyone else?

A No.

Q So are you and Courtney Jones the two Vons employees responsible for conducting individualized assessments for the Fair Chance Act?

A Yes.

Q Anyone else?

A No.

Q Did anyone else other than you work on gathering documents in response to Plaintiff's request

have received pre-adverse action notices that state "We have identified the following convictions on your report to be job-related: Sex offender"?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope the notice topics, calls for speculation.

MR. DRURY: Join.

THE DEPONENT: No.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Do you know if Asurint maintains records of which candidates receive pre-adverse action notices such as this one stating "We have identified the following convictions on your report to be job-related: Sex offender"?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope of the notice topics, calls for speculation.

MR. DRURY: Join.

THE DEPONENT: I don't know.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Does Vons have access to pre-adverse action notices through Asurint's portal?

A Yes.

Q Have you checked Asurint's portal for any pre-adverse action notices relating to Mr. Carrillo?

A Yes.

Q What did you find?

"We are writing to inform you that your conditional offer of employment, transfer or promotion with Vons/Pavilions has been withdrawn.

"This decision was influenced in whole or in part by a pre-employment screening report prepared by Asurint. Please note that Asurint did not make this employment decision on behalf of our company. This decision was made pursuant to Vons/Pavilions hiring policies.

"We have identified the following convictions on your report to be job-related: Sex Offender."

So based on this adverse action notice, what is this e-mail stating was the basis for withdrawing Mr. Carrillo's conditional offer of employment?

MS. LAMAR: Objection to the extent this says that it's an e-mail, misstates the document.

MR. DRURY: Join.

THE DEPONENT: That we made a decision in whole or in part on the pre-employment screening report.

BY MR. KIM:

Q And what information in the pre-employment screening report did Vons/Pavilions rely on in

withdrawing the offer?

A His previous conviction disclosure and his conviction as a sex offender.

Q Does this letter mention a previous conviction disclosure?

MS. LAMAR: The document speaks for itself.

THE DEPONENT: No. It's covered in the pre-adverse, and it's included in the background report.

BY MR. KIM:

Q So would you agree with me that this adverse action notice only states that the decision to withdraw the conditional offer of employment was based on the sex offender information contained in the background report?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; misstates the document, asked and answered, argumentative.

MR. DRURY: Join in the objections.

THE DEPONENT: No.

MR. KIM: I'm sorry. Madam Court Reporter, can you repeat my question and the response?

(Record read.)

BY MR. KIM:

Q So why would you say no, Ms. North?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; the document speaks for itself, misstates what the document says, and asked and answered, argumentative.

time of their offer.

Q So then what does -- so does Fail mean that they failed because of a conviction reported on their record?

A Yes.

Q And then does Disclosure mean that they failed because of information they disclosed?

A Yes, previous conviction information that they disclosed.

Q And then I'm in the 2024 California Vons All Divisions.

Do you see that here at the bottom?

A Yes.

Q Okay. So does this reflect all of the fails for The Vons Companies?

A I don't know. It's all of the fails with the Vons banner.

Q Okay. By "Vons banner," are you referring just to the stores called Vons?

A Yes.

Q Okay. So then this would not include Pavilions; is that right?

A Yes.

Q And it would not include Albertsons; is that right?

Q For Major Category?

A Yes, because we don't log what the crime was. We don't have that information, necessarily.

Q I'm sorry. So you said Disclosure signifies what again?

A Disclosure signifies that somebody disclosed a previous conviction at time of offer that we think is job-related.

Q And Column M?

A That's the number of convictions on the background check report that we consider to be job-related.

Q And then I believe the rest of these are redacted.

So going back to -- in Category. So again, we said here there are ten candidates, if we count these, ten out of 115 records.

So does the same analysis with respect to each of the columns apply for 2023?

A You mean the description of the columns?

Q Yes.

A Yes.

Q Okay. And then also the descriptions of each -- let me just do this -- of like the Highest Crime, would what we discussed for 2024 also apply to this 2023

Highest Crime to Sex Offender and the reason for fail is job-related and the order score is fail, then that candidate did not receive employment as a result of their sex offender status?

A No.

Q Why not?

A They also could have disclosed a sex crime that we consider job-related.

Q I'm sorry. I didn't understand what you said. Could you say that again, please?

A They could also have disclosed a crime that we consider to be job-related. So we would be looking both at the sex offender and their disclosure.

Q But then it would say Disclosure --

A Well, it only says --

Q -- here, wouldn't it?

A It only says Disclosure if they did not have a criminal conviction in their background report.

Q Okay. So you're stating that it could have also been like Mr. Carrillo, that the candidate disclosed that they had some type of sexual crime --

MS. LAMAR: Asked and answered.

BY MR. KIM:

Q -- in their history?

MS. LAMAR: Asked and answered.

consumer report. If they remain a fail after the waiting period, they're going to get the adverse action.

BY MR. KIM:

Q And if their highest crime is sex offender, it'll state in the adverse action notice "sex offender"?

MS. LAMAR: Asked and answered.

THE DEPONENT: Yes, because that's the format we have to follow in California.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Was this information obtained from the Asurint portal or from Vons's records?

A From the Asurint portal.

MR. DRURY: I'd just object to the form.

I'm not sure what you mean by "this information."

BY MR. KIM:

Q Was this information contained in this report that we are looking at, Bates Number 138, obtained from the Asurint portal or from Vons's records?

THE DEPONENT: Thank you for the clarification, Mr. Drury. I answered that incorrectly.

The vast majority of this information comes from Asurint, but the stuff that's logged manually is from Vons.

So Columns G through N are all manually input

by Courtney Jones and myself.

BY MR. KIM:

Q How about the other columns?

A I would have to see what has been redacted to answer that question.

Q So, Ms. North, to make sure that I'm understanding your testimony, are you stating that the information contained in this report, here it would be Columns A through AL, Rows 1 through 173, this information was manually entered into this spreadsheet?

A It was pulled from reports, and then it was put together --

(Failure of transmission.)

BY MR. KIM:

Q I'm sorry. I couldn't hear you.

A I get reports each month. And so I took each of those reports and put them together to create what you see before you.

Q Are the reports in this same format?

A No.

Q Do the reports contain the same columns reflected, A through AL, in this document?

A No. I add G through N because those are manual to Vons --

(Failure of transmission.)

BY MR. KIM:

Q How about Safeway?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope of the notice topics.

THE DEPONENT: Yes.

BY MR. KIM:

Q I'm sorry. Yes to what?

A Yes to --

(Simultaneous colloquy.)

MS. LAMAR: Give me a second.

Same objection; outside the scope of the notice topics.

THE DEPONENT: Yes to Safeway.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Okay. So you are aware of candidates who fall under the category of sex crimes who were hired by Safeway since January 2021?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope of the notice topics.

THE DEPONENT: Yes.

BY MR. KIM:

Q How do you know that?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope of the notice topics.

THE DEPONENT: Because it was an exception. It

was someone who was working in our corporate offices and who had a conviction for viewing child pornography.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Viewing child pornography?

A Yes.

Q So that was similar, then, to Mr. Carrillo; isn't that right?

A Yes.

Q So why was an exception made for this individual?

A They weren't going to be --

(Simultaneous colloquy.)

MS. LAMAR: Mr. Kim cut off.

Would you mind repeating your question?

And then I'm going to insert an objection, but I didn't because I thought he was pausing.

DEPOSITION REPORTER: Did you need it read back, Mr. Kim?

MR. KIM: I could repeat it.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Why was an exception made for this individual?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope of the notice topics.

THE DEPONENT: This person was not going to have contact with the public as part of his job, so there

were no at-risk minors or at-risk adults that he was going to be around.

BY MR. KIM:

Q And who would be considered an at-risk adult?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; outside the scope of the notice topics.

THE DEPONENT: We would say anybody that's elderly, has any sort of disability, anything that would be considered an elderly dependent, child, all of those at-risk categories.

BY MR. KIM:

Q And who would be considered an at-risk minor?

A I would say any minor would be an at-risk minor.

Q What position was this candidate hired for?

MS. LAMAR: Objection --

(Simultaneous colloquy.)

MS. LAMAR: So for all of these, this has nothing to do with Vons. So I'll be objecting that it's outside the scope, so just give me a second to object.

THE DEPONENT: Sorry.

MS. LAMAR: No apologies needed.

Objection; outside the scope of the notice topics.

THE DEPONENT: I don't remember. I believe it

MR. KIM: And I was referring specifically to this one e-mail.

BY MR. KIM:

Q So here he states:

"I would like to know if I can apply for other positions for which my offense is not related, such as overnight stocking clerk."

Did Vons take into account Mr. Carrillo's request to be employed as an overnight stocking clerk?

A I don't know because it wouldn't have made any difference. It requires the same contact with at-risk people, so we would have had the same decision.

Q Who would the at-risk people be working overnight in stocking?

MS. LAMAR: Objection; assumes facts.

THE DEPONENT: Our overnight stocking clerks work during the day as well. They work in the early morning when we have a lot of elderly, at-risk people coming in.

But also, they're going to be working side by side, again, with minors in the stores.

BY MR. KIM:

Q Does --

A The other thing to note is that we don't do

REPORTER'S CERTIFICATE

I, MICHELLE DICHIRICO, Certified Shorthand Reporter, California Certificate Number 13779, certify:

That the foregoing proceedings were taken before me at the time therein set forth, at which time the witness was put under oath by me;

That the testimony of the witness, the questions propounded, and all objections and statements made at the time of the examination were recorded stenographically by me and were thereafter transcribed;

That the foregoing is a true and correct transcript of my shorthand notes so taken.

I further certify that I am not a relative or employee of any attorney of the parties, nor financially interested in the action.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Dated this 10th day of November, 2025.

Michelle Dichirico

MICHELLE DICHIRICO, CSR 13779